

The DBT Skills Workbook for Beginners - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

The Crisis Card

STOP: stop; take a step back; observe; proceed mindfully.

TIPP: cold water on the face 30 s / 10 min hard exercise / breathe out long for 3 min / tense and release.

Then distract (my three): _____

Then self-soothe (my three): _____

The person I text or call: _____

If it is a safety crisis: 988 / 116 123 / my doctor / the emergency department.

The DEAR MAN Card

Priority this time: objective / relationship / self-respect

Describe (facts only) -> **Express** ("I feel...") -> **Assert** (the ask or the no, one sentence) -> **Reinforce** (what is in it for them)

Mindful (broken record, ignore attacks) -> **Appear confident** (voice, eyes, posture) -> **Negotiate** (the fallback)

GIVE: gentle, interested, validate, easy manner. **FAST:** fair, no apologies, stick to values, truthful.

The Bad-Week Card

This is a bad week, not a verdict.

PLEASE first: sleep, food, no substances, the medicine, a walk.

The crisis card. The pros and cons list. The person.

Check the facts on the emotion driving it; opposite action if it does not fit; radical acceptance if it cannot be changed.

I do not decide anything big this week.

If it becomes a safety crisis: 988 / 116 123 / my doctor, today.

Worksheet 3.1 - The emotion check

For the last two weeks, rate each line 0 (never), 1 (sometimes), 2 (often), 3 (nearly always).

	0-3
My emotions come on fast and strong	
They take a long time to come down	
I do things in the heat of the moment that I regret	
I have hurt myself, or thought about it, to cope with a feeling	
I use food, alcohol, drugs, spending or screens to switch off a feeling	
My relationships blow up, or I end them, when I am upset	
I have trouble saying no, or asking for what I need, without either giving in or exploding	
I feel empty, or numb, between the storms	
I see people and situations as all good or all bad	
I do not know what I am feeling until it is very big	
Total (0-30)	

Score it again at the end of Week 8 and at three months. There is no cut-off; the number is a baseline, and most people who need this book score over 15.

Worksheet 3.2 - The problem behaviours

The things you do when the emotion is in charge that cost you: name them, count them for the last month, and write what they cost.

Behaviour (shouting, cutting, bingeing, drinking, spending, ghosting, quitting, self-attack...)	Times in the last month	What it costs me	The emotion usually behind it

Worksheet 3.3 - Safety

If any of the behaviours is self-harm, an overdose, or a plan to end your life, this program is not enough on its own, and the people who can help are: your doctor; the crisis line for your country (988 in the US; 116 123 in the UK and Ireland; findahelpline.com elsewhere); the emergency department; and the full DBT programmes in Chapter 11. Write the numbers here, now, before Week 1.

My doctor	
The crisis line	
The person I will call at 2 a.m.	
The nearest emergency department	
The reason I want to still be here in a year (one line, in my words)	

Worksheet 1.1 - Observe practice log

Day	Morning (2 min) done	Evening (2 min) done	How many times the mind wandered (a guess)	What I noticed most (body, thought, sound, urge)
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Worksheet 1.2 - Describe: one emotion a day

Day	The situation (facts only)	"I notice _____ at ___/5"	"...and the urge to _____"	Did I act on the urge?	What wise mind would say
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Weekly review

Observe practices completed (out of 14)	
The emotion that came up most this week	
The urge I noticed most, and how often I acted on it	
One moment where describing ("I notice...") changed what I did	
One activity I participated in fully, and what it was like	
Wise mind: did I find it? On what?	
Ready for Week 2? (at least ten observe practices done)	

Worksheet 2.1 - Judgement watch

Day	The judgement (exact words)	Of whom	The facts	The feeling underneath	The rewrite (facts + feeling)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Worksheet 2.2 - The diary card, Week 2

Every evening. Emotions and urges 0 (none) to 5 (extreme). Behaviours: tick if acted on. Skills: the letters you used (O observe, D describe, P participate, NJ non-judgemental, OM one-mindful, E effective; later weeks add theirs).

Day	Strongest emotions today (name, 0-5)	Urges (name, 0-5)	Acted on?	Skills used	Sleep (hours)	Notes
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Weekly review

Diary card completed on how many evenings	
The judgement I make most, and of whom	
One judgement I rewrote, and what changed	
One-mindful meals: how many, and what I noticed	
One situation where "what works?" changed my action	
The pattern the diary shows already (time, trigger, person)	
Ready for Week 3? (the diary card done at least five evenings)	

Worksheet 3.1 - My crisis card

STOP: freeze; step back; observe; proceed mindfully	
TIPP: cold water 30 s / 10 min hard exercise / breathe out long for 3 min / tense and release	
Then distract (my three): 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____	
Then self-soothe (my three): 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____	
The person I text or call: _____	
The thing I do not do tonight, whatever the feeling says: _____	
If it is a safety crisis: 988 / 116 123 / my doctor / the emergency department	

Worksheet 3.2 - TIPP practice and crisis log

Day	TIPP practised (which)	Crisis this week? (what)	Peak emotion (0-5)	Skills used, in order	Acted on the urge?	What happened
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Worksheet 3.3 - Pros and cons of the crisis behaviour

The behaviour: _____

	Pros	Cons
Doing it		
Not doing it (using the skills instead)		

Read this in the storm, not after.

Weekly review

Crisis card made and where I keep it	
TIPP skills practised on a calm day (which, and what they did)	
Crises this week, and the highest peak	
The skills that worked, in order	
Urges acted on this week, against Week 2's diary card	
The pros and cons list: written? Read in a storm?	
Ready for Week 4?	

Worksheet 4.1 - The fact I am accepting

The fact, in plain words, no judgement	
What I have been saying about it ("it shouldn't", "it isn't fair", "I can't")	
The causes: it happened because...	
What fighting it has cost me	
What I can still change, and what I cannot	
The willing action, if any	

Worksheet 4.2 - Turning the mind tally

Day	Times the fight came back (tally)	Times I turned the mind	What turning felt like	Wilfulness noticed	The willing thing I did
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Weekly review

The fact I worked on, and how accepted it is now (0-10)	
How many times a day the fight came back at the start and at the end of the week	
Wilfulness noticed, and the willing thing done	
Did the half-smile and willing hands do anything?	
Crises this week and the skills used	
The diary card pattern this week	
Ready for Week 5?	

Worksheet 5.1 - Naming the emotion

Day	Prompting event (facts)	Interpretation (what I told myself)	Body (where, what)	Urge	What I did	Emotion name and 0-5	Secondary emotion?
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							

Worksheet 5.2 - Checking the facts

	Emotion 1	Emotion 2
The emotion and its intensity (0-5)		
The event, as a camera saw it		
My assumption or interpretation		
Evidence for the assumption		
Evidence against; other explanations		
The threat I am assuming, and how likely it really is		
If the worst happened, could I cope? How?		
Verdict: fits the facts / does not / fits but too intense		
Therefore: act on it (how) / opposite action (Week 6)		

Weekly review

Emotions named fully this week	
The emotion I feel most, and its usual urge	
The secondary emotion that piles on most often	
The two fact-checks and their verdicts	
One emotion that did not fit the facts, and what I did instead	
Diary card: peaks this week against Week 2	
Ready for Week 6?	

Worksheet 6.1 - Opposite action

Day	The emotion (0-5)	Its urge	Does it fit the facts?	The opposite action (all the way: body, face, voice)	Did I do it?	Emotion after (0-5)
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						

Worksheet 6.2 - PLEASE, positives, mastery and cope ahead

Day	PL: illness treated	E: ate regularly	A: no substances	S: slept 7+	E: exercised 20 min	Pleasant event done	Mastery thing done
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							

Cope ahead	
The event I dread this week	
The emotion I expect and its urge	
The skills I will use, in order	
Rehearsed in the mind on (date), how it went	
What actually happened	

Weekly review

Opposite actions done, and the emotion that changed most	
PLEASE: which line I failed most, and what it does to the diary card	
Pleasant events done, and the one I will repeat	
Mastery: the hard thing I did	
Cope ahead: the event, and how it went against how I feared it would	
Diary card: peaks and urges against Week 2	
Ready for Week 7?	

Worksheet 7.1 - My DEAR MAN

The person, and what I want (or want to refuse)	
Priority this time: objective / relationship / self-respect	
Describe (facts only)	
Express ("I feel...")	
Assert (the ask or the no, in one sentence)	
Reinforce (what is in it for them)	
Mindful (my broken-record sentence)	
Appear confident (what I will do with voice and body)	
Negotiate (my fallback)	
GIVE: how I will stay gentle, interested, validating, easy	
FAST: the value I will not sell	
Delivered on; what happened	

Worksheet 7.2 - Validation and refusal log

Day	Who I validated and what I said	Their response	A no I said (FAST)	Apologised?	Relationship afterwards (better / same / worse)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Weekly review

The DEAR MAN: delivered? The outcome	
The priority I chose, and whether it was the right one	
Validations given, and the one that surprised the other person	
The no I said, and how it felt	
The conversation I used the crisis skills around	
Diary card: relationship storms this week against Week 2	
Ready for Week 8?	

Worksheet 8.1 - Dialectic watch and self-validation

Day	The either/or I caught ("all... / never... / either...")	The both/and	Self-validation: "I feel ____, and that makes sense because ____"	What wise mind says to do
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Worksheet 8.2 - The eight-week review

	Week 2 (first diary week)	Week 8
Emotion check total (Worksheet 3.1)		
Average strongest emotion on the diary card (0-5)		
Urges acted on, in the week		
Problem behaviours (Worksheet 3.2), in the week		
Nights of 7+ hours, out of 7		
Relationship storms, in the week		
Crises got through with the skills		

What has changed in eight weeks	
What has not	
The skill that helped most	
The skill I still cannot do	
Whether I need more than this book (Chapter 11), honestly	

Worksheet 8.3 - My plan

The five skills I keep (by name)	
The daily practice I continue (how long, when)	
The diary card: daily / weekly / on bad days	
The PLEASE line I have to watch	
The person who knows I am doing this	
The bad-week card (Chapter 9), copied and kept where	
The sign that means I need more help, and what I will do the same day	

Weekly review

Either/ors caught and turned this week	
Self-validations: did they change what I did?	
The emotion check: then and now	
The five skills chosen	
The plan written and the card copied	
Whether I need more help, and what I will do about it	
What I would tell someone on the first day of this program	

Worksheet 9.1 - My bad-week card

The sign it is a bad week (from my diary card)	
PLEASE: the line I fix first	
The crisis skills, in my order: STOP, TIPP (which), distract (my three), soothe (my three)	
The emotion that usually drives my bad weeks, and its opposite action	
The fact I keep having to accept	
The person I tell	
The number I call if it becomes a safety crisis: 988 / 116 123 / _____	
The decision I do not make this week	

Worksheet 11.1 - My help plan

My doctor (name, number)	
The crisis line for where I live	
The person I will call at 2 a.m.	
The nearest emergency department	
A DBT skills group or full DBT programme near me (found on)	
A therapist I could see (found on)	
The sign that would mean I need more than this book (from the list above)	
What I will do, the same day, if I see it	

Blank diary card

Emotions and urges 0 to 5; behaviours ticked if acted on; skills by their letters (O D P NJ OM E; STOP TIPP AC SS; RA TM W; N CF; OA PL AP BM CA; DM G F; MP SV).

Day	Strongest emotions (name, 0-5)	Urges (name, 0-5)	Acted on?	Skills used	Sleep (hours)	Notes
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Blank checking-the-facts sheet

The emotion and its intensity (0-5)	
The event, as a camera saw it	
My assumption or interpretation	
Evidence for	
Evidence against; other explanations	
The threat, and how likely	
If the worst happened, could I cope? How?	
Verdict: fits / does not fit / fits but too intense	
Therefore: act on it (how) / opposite action (what)	

Blank opposite action log

Day	Emotion (0-5)	Urge	Fits the facts?	Opposite action, all the way	Done?	Emotion after

Blank DEAR MAN

Person and goal; priority (objective / relationship / self-respect)	
Describe	
Express	
Assert	
Reinforce	
Mindful (broken record)	
Appear confident	
Negotiate	
GIVE and FAST reminders	
Delivered on; outcome	

Blank crisis log

Date	The crisis	Peak (0-5)	Skills used, in order	Acted on the urge?	What happened	What I will do differently

The twelve-week tracker

Week	Diary cards done	Average strongest emotion (0-5)	Urges acted on	Crises got through with skills	Nights 7+ hours	PLEASE lines kept (of 5)	Notes
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
11							
12							